

CORN PLANT

Dracaena fragrans

This is one of the heavyweights of the houseplant world—and a great guzzler of toxins, too. Its treelike trunks and clusters of bicolored foliage, growing to head height, mean it has great impact in any home. I bought them in their thousands when I worked in the trade.

“I’ll be a striking natural presence in your room.”

Help me thrive



POSITION

Needs filtered light, as direct sunlight will burn the plant, but too little light may cause the leaves to lose their stripes. Keep at around 65°F (18°C).



GROWTH RATE

Can grow up to 6½ft (2m) tall and more than 3¼ft (1m) wide. If the plant grows taller than you want, you can cut off the top of the canes.



POTTING

Repot every year or two in spring into a slightly larger container with fresh potting soil, but don’t pack it too much so as to retain good drainage.



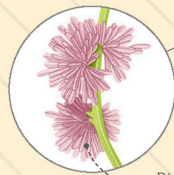
CARE

Allow the soil to dry out a little before watering in spring and summer. Reduce watering in winter. In the growing season, fertilize frequently.



I will bring the outside in

I am a big player in softening the harshness of a room. Since I can grow up to 6½ft (2m) tall, I will be a striking presence when stood in the corner of your room, where I will bring a touch of nature indoors. My living foliage will make your house feel alive and more like a home.



Pink-white starburst flowers may shoot from my crown



My flowers are a rare treat

Although it’s a rare sight when I’m grown indoors, I can flower when I mature. When my white flowers appear, you will realize why my name is *fragrans*—their scent is very strong and sweet. Some people choose to pinch off my flower buds so I can put more energy into my foliage.